



Ahead of summit, Putin has his way

Russian is redrawing global power dynamics with Trump one-on-one

BY ROBYN DIXON, FRANCESCA EBEL AND CATHERINE BELTON

Even before talks begin, President Vladimir Putin's meeting with President Donald Trump at a U.S. military base in Alaska on Friday is advancing the Russian's goal of redrawing the global security order, as the two men revive a great-power system in which a few big countries call the shots.

Putin set the scene last week after meeting Trump's envoy Steve Witkoff, when he ruled out meeting Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky until certain conditions were met — conditions that he said remained “far off.”

Trump agreed and dismissed the idea of Zelensky's attendance, even as the future of his nation — and its 40 million citizens — hangs in the balance.

Zelensky had been in many meetings in 3½ years — since the start of Russia's invasion — Trump said Monday, and “nothing happened. ... I mean, do you want somebody that's been doing this for 3½ years?”

A tête-à-tête summit, on U.S. soil, was not Putin's only important win. He also diverted, for now, Trump's threat of tough economic sanctions against Russian oil and deflected Trump's calls for a ceasefire. On Monday, Trump was back to blaming Zelensky for the war — echoing Putin

SEE SUMMIT ON A11

Donbas: Ukrainians confront the prospect of losing the region. **A10**

Past summits: In his first term, Trump met Putin several times. **A11**



TOM BRENNER/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

BY SABRINA RODRIGUEZ

MISSION, TEXAS — As Texas Republicans draw new congressional maps intended to boost their party's chances of keeping control of the U.S. House next year, they are betting on Latino voters like Yzeña Cuellar.

Cuellar, a 48-year-old middle school science teacher who was raised as a Democrat, broke with her family and voted last year for President Donald Trump. But that does not make her a Republican, she said, noting that she voted for Democrats in other races and may do so again next year.

“Am I going to say it's just Republicans from now on? No,” Cuellar said Sunday evening at her partner's ranch near the U.S. southern border. “I'm not going to be a shut door. I'm going to be open to both sides.”

Political leaders in Washington and Austin have assumed that the

GOP maps bet big on Latino vote

Bid to keep control of Congress depends in part on preserving gains with Hispanics in Texas

Rick Salinas looks out at the family cemetery Sunday in La Grulla, Texas. He backed Donald Trump last year.

five newly drawn congressional districts — which Trump would have won by at least 10 percentage points in last year's election — will be safe Republican seats if the Texas legislature approves them. The battle over altering the maps in Texas has escalated into a broader national fight, with Texas Democratic lawmakers leaving the state to delay a vote and governors in blue states threatening to retaliate by redrawing their own maps.

But the new maps in Texas, to varying degrees, depend on Republicans keeping voters like Cuellar and expanding on Trump's historic inroads among Latinos in South Texas and across the country. Three of the five newly drawn Republican districts will have a higher percentage of Hispanic voters.

SEE TEXAS ON A6

Redistricting: Personal toll weighs on Democrats who fled Texas. **A7**

Federal efforts to last all day at D.C. ‘hot spots,’ tent sites

This article is by Paul Kiefer, Kyle Swenson, Alex Horton, Tara Copp and Michael Laris

President Donald Trump on Thursday promised to “have the crime situation solved in D.C. very soon,” as White House and Pentagon officials provided some new details about the increased presence of federal law enforcement and National Guard troops in the capital.

A White House official said federal operations will run 24 hours a day, rather than focus on nighttime hours, and will target high crime areas and “known hot spots.” There were also signs of stepped-up efforts to address the tents and other visible signs of homelessness that have long seized Trump's attention.

But on what was the first full

day of National Guard operations in the District, Trump also continued to face questions on the practical impact of his extraordinary use of federal power. Speaking to reporters in the Oval Office, he defended his assertion that National Guard troops can make a meaningful difference — despite their lack of training in local police work.

National Guard troops are trained in “common sense, and they're very tough people,” Trump said. He later added that “they're trained in not allowing people to burn down buildings and bomb buildings and shoot people and all the things.”

D.C. police data shows violent

SEE D.C. ON A5

ICE cooperation: D.C. police to aid immigration enforcement. **B13**



ASTRID RIECKEN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

People take down tents Thursday in an encampment for the homeless near the Kennedy Center.

Child vaccines will get review

HHS RESURRECTS SAFETY TASK FORCE

Return represents a win for immunization critics

BY RACHEL ROUBEIN AND LENA H. SUN

The Department of Health and Human Services said Thursday it is reviving a long-defunct task force aimed at improving the safety of childhood vaccines, fulfilling a demand of anti-vaccine activists.

The resurrection of the panel appears to be the first concrete step to achieve HHS Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s longtime goal of upending the current childhood immunization schedule, which recommends which shots children receive and when.

The task force will make recommendations focused on developing and refining childhood vaccines that result in “fewer and less serious adverse reactions,” improving the reporting of adverse reactions and supporting research on vaccine safety, according to HHS. The first report will be sent to Congress within two years.

“By reinstating this Task Force, we are reaffirming our commitment to rigorous science, continuous improvement, and the trust of American families,” Jay Bhattacharya, the head of the National Institutes of Health, who will lead the task force, said in a statement. “NIH is proud to lead this effort to advance vaccine safety and support innovation that protects children without compromise.”

Some vaccine and medical experts said they are concerned the task force will undermine trust in vaccines, even if the goal of improving vaccine safety is laudable.

“What I am concerned about is

SEE VACCINES ON A16

Trump bends data to fit his agenda in risk to public trust

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, DAVID OVALLE, SCOTT DANCE AND LAURA MECKLER

President Donald Trump presented inaccurate crime statistics to justify a federal takeover of D.C. police. He announced plans for the census to stop counting undocumented immigrants. And he ordered the firing of the official in charge of compiling basic statistics about the U.S. economy after a weak jobs report.

This month marked an escalation in Trump's war on data, as he repeatedly tries to undermine statistics that threaten his agenda and distorts figures to bolster his policies. The latest instances come on top of actions the administration has taken across federal health, climate and education agencies to erase or overhaul data collection to align with the administration's agenda and worldview.

The president's manipulation of government data threatens to erode public trust in facts that leaders of both parties have long relied on to guide policy decisions. A breakdown in official government statistics could also

SEE TRUMP ON A15

White House cutbacks put research labs on heels, imperil U.S. status as scientific superpower

BY CAROLYN Y. JOHNSON

WORCESTER, MASS. — Anastasia Khvorova is perched at the edge of a massive scientific opportunity. Her laboratory at the University of Massachusetts Chan Medical School deploys cutting-edge RNA biology with one aim: to solve diseases — the ones that rob people of their memories or

endanger pregnant women.

Lately, she sees peril all around her.

In the hallway, she bumps into one world-class chemist, then another, whose salaries are supported by “indirect” federal funding the Trump administration has proposed to drastically slash. Many are immigrants like herself, who can no longer be sure

America is the best country in the world to do science — or that they are welcome. Khvorova built her career by thinking boldly, but if slowdowns and cuts to federal science funding continue, she'll be forced to winnow her ambitions.

“What is happening right now is absolutely suicidal,” said Khvorova, speaking softly in Russian-

accented English. “I will stop making drugs. I will reduce my lab from 30 people to five. I will stop training scientists.”

With stunning speed, the Trump administration has over the past six months cut research dollars, terminated grants and hit the brakes on federal funding, destabilizing an 80-year-old partnership between the govern-

ment and universities that has made the United States a scientific superpower.

The policy twists may sound arcane, but to researchers, everything is at stake.

Day-to-day, Khvorova's lab is bright and buzzing. Scientists are trying to develop cures for Huntington's disease or halt the

SEE LABS ON A8

IN THE NEWS

Americans are sobering up Just over half of U.S. adults said that they drink alcohol, the lowest finding by Gallup since it began polling on the issue 86 years ago. **A4**

A lifeline, severed At least 12 colleges across six states have closed their campus cultural hubs in response to anti-DEI efforts. **A3**

THE NATION **Kari Lake** told a judge she is following the law with her cuts to Voice of America. **A3**
Florida Gov. Ron DeSantis announced plans to open a second migrant detention site. **A7**

THE WORLD **The U.S.-India** relationship is being threatened by friction between the nations' leaders. **A12**
Israeli strategizing has exposed a rift between civilian and military leaders. **A13**

THE ECONOMY **Gold is glittering** like never before in Trump's Washington, with the precious metal seeing a price surge and adorning the Oval Office. **A14**
After losing in court, the Trump administration said it will unfreeze funding to build EV charging stations. **A14**

STYLE **After 35 years,** the artist behind the CIA's encrypted “Kryptos” sculpture will sell its final secret. **B1**

SPORTS **The NBA** released its full schedule with games across no fewer than six platforms. We break down the key games. **B7**

THE REGION **Two weeks** after a sit-in at an immigration enforcement site in Baltimore, lawmakers returned for a tour. **B13**

WEEKEND **Revisit nine moments** that helped cement the legacy of Arena Stage, which this week marks its 75th anniversary.

BUSINESS NEWS.....A14
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B16
OPINION PAGES.....A17
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A10

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